

Eric Atanga Ayamga

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Research Interests

Applied Microeconomics, Applied Econometrics, Industrial Organization, Health Policy, Energy Transition

Education

Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX Expected June 2027

Ph.D. in Economics

Thesis:

Committee: Michael Noel (Chair), Victoria Ziqi Hang (co-chair), Misak Avestiyan

Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi, Ghana 2022

MPhil. in Economics

Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi, Ghana 2019

B.A. in Economics

References

Michael D Noel

Professor of Economics

Department of Economics, Texas Tech University

Email: Michael.Noel@ttu.edu

Misak Avestiyan

Associate Professor and Associate Chair of Economics

Department of Economics, Texas Tech University

Email: Misak.Avestiyan@ttu.edu

Victoria Hang

Assistant Professor of Economics; Associate Graduate Program Director

Department of Economics, Texas Tech University

Email: Victoria.Hang@ttu.edu

Working Papers

Do Front-of-Package Sugar Labels Shift Consumer Demand away from Diabetes-Risk Foods? (Job Market Paper), submitted

I use U.S. retail scanner data to study the effectiveness of the 2016 FDA Nutrition Facts label revision. I find only modest effects on consumer demand with limited substitution away from high-sugar products. To explain these findings, I develop and estimate a structural random-coefficients demand model with rational inattention, in which consumers face information-processing costs when acquiring nutritional information. The model estimates reveal that consumers pay little attention

to the current Nutrition Facts label because of the high cognitive cost. I then use the model to compare the current labels with other much simpler labels. The results show that warning labels substantially reduced information-processing cost and sugar consumption by 36% through consumer substitution and product reformulation. Overall, our findings suggest that reducing cognitive costs through simplified FOP designs can meaningfully improve consumer welfare and shift consumption away from unhealthy products. [Paper link](#)

The Cost of Inaccessibility: Retail Discrimination and Mobility-Constrained Consumers (With Li Zeng and Victoria Hang)

This study investigates whether individuals with mobility-related health conditions face systematic disadvantages in retail pricing, both in physical stores and on online platforms. While price discrimination is a common feature of modern markets, limited attention has been paid to how physical mobility constraints may affect consumers' ability to access lower prices or respond to promotions. Using matched observational data from the NielsenIQ and the Open E-Commerce dataset, we compare purchasing behavior and price outcomes between consumers with and without mobility-related health conditions. We find that mobility-constrained individuals pay modestly higher prices in physical stores and face even larger price disparities in online purchases, particularly among wheelchair users. Our findings highlight mobility as an underexamined axis of vulnerability in consumer markets. The results have implications for the design of retail pricing systems and digital platforms, as well as for policy efforts aimed at improving equity in access to essential goods.

Work in Progress

Hotter Days, Sweet Choices: Temperature Extremes and Consumer Food Choice

This paper examines the impact of extreme heat exposure on consumer demand for added sugars. Using high-frequency retail scanner data combined with detailed local weather information and I find that an increase in the number of extreme hot days leads to a statistically and economically significant rise in the demand for added sugars. The effect is nonlinear, with stronger responses observed at higher temperature thresholds and during prolonged heat episodes. These findings have important implications for both climate policy and public health.

Front-of-Package Sugar Label and Consumer Demand: Heterogeneous Evidence Across Categories

Optimal Nutrition Policy: Nutrition Labels Versus Sugar Taxes

Research Publications

- Decomposed Oil-Driven Inflation and Asymmetric Shocks. Published in **Studies in Nonlinear Dynamics & Econometrics** (with Joseph Agyapong)
- Forecasting the Future: Applying Bayesian Model Averaging for Exchange Rates Drivers in Ghana. Published in **Applied Economics** (with J. Agyapong and S.I. Anyars)
- The Macroeconomic Impact of Energy Transition Metal Prices: Nonlinear Evidence from IEA Economies. Published in **Journal of Commodity Markets** (with J. Agyapong and Lordia Yalley)
- The Environmental Impact of International Trade in Sub-Saharan Africa: Exploring the Role of Policy and Institutions for Environmental Sustainability. Published in **Research in Global-**

- ization** (with D. Mpuure, E. Doudu, and AB. Abille)
- Pricing of Climate Risks in Capital Markets of South Africa. Published in **Journal of Developing Areas** (with E. Amporfu and D. Sakyi)

Referee Services

Referee: *International Economics and Economic Policy* (3 papers)

Referee: *South African Journal of Economics* (1 paper)

Referee: *African Development Review* (1 paper)

Teaching Experience

Instructor

- TTU - Eco 2301 Principles of Microeconomics Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026

Teaching Assistant

- TTU - Eco 6312 Microeconomics II (Game Theory) Spring 2024
- TTU - Eco 5311 Macroeconomic Theory and Policy Fall 2023
- KNUST- Econ Microeconomic Theory I, Semester I, 2022
- KNUST Mathematical Economics, Semester I, 2022
- KNUST Econometric Theory I, Semester II, 2022
- TTU Monetary Economics, TTU Spring 2025
- TTU - Eco 3305 Game Theory, TTU Spring 2024
- TTU Principles of Money, Banking, and Credit, TTU Fall 2023
- TTU Intermediate Macroeconomics, TTU Spring 2023
- TTU Principles of Microeconomics, TTU Fall 2022
- KNUST - Econ 479/480 Advanced Econometrics I & II Fall 2019, Spring 2020
- KNUST - Econ 463/464 Environmental and Resource Economics I Fall 2019, Spring 2020

Honors and Awards

- Graduate Part-Time Instructor, Texas Tech University Fall 2025
- Dr Rashid Al-Hmoud Fellowship, Texas Tech University 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
- Graduate Students Research Support Fund, Texas Tech University 2025
- Faculty Dean Award, Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology 2019
- Best Economics Student Award, Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology 2019
- Best Economics Student Award, Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology 2018

Conference Presentations

- Midwest Economic Association Conference 2025
- ASSA/AEA Annual Meeting 2024, 2025
- International Studies Association Annual Meeting 2025
- Arts and Humanities Annual Conference 2023, 2024, 2025

Skills

Programming and Software: Stata, Python, R, MATLAB, Excel, EViews, HTML, L^AT_EX